

there is anything dishonest or misleading in the majority of such documents.

On the other hand, few laymen are able to follow the labyrinthine mazes of legal terminology which are used in them. To avoid misunderstandings, it is always best to have an attorney translate the "whereas"-studded fine-print clauses into coherent everyday English. Even seasoned real estate investors sometimes fail to have this done—and the ensuing squabbles between buyers and sellers usually wind up in courtrooms.

9. Always insure the title to any property you buy. Even the most meticulous title search may fail to turn up all the pertinent facts about the history of a property. The cost of title insurance is negligible. The expense of fighting a lawsuit

over a clouded title can be staggering—as many real estate investors, I among them, have discovered to their regret.

10. Once you've bought your property, treat it as a long-term investment, not as a short-term speculation. You'll find

that—99 times out of a hundred—you'll make much greater

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profits that way. In fact, if you wish to make money in real estate, always think in terms of investing and never in terms

of speculating.

These ten pointers do not, by any means, comprise an all-inclusive guide to successful real estate investment. Nor does the individual who follows them—however faithfully—

have any guarantee that he will make a profit when he invests his money in real property.

But, I believe that the person who observes these rules goes a long way toward eliminating a significant portion of the most common dangers